
UQ Fintech Society × IMC Trading

AlgoJam 3

Event Information & Submission Guidelines

August 2026

Introduction

AlgoJam 3 is a digital trading competition run by UQ Fintech Society. Every submission should be your team's own original work; cheating, plagiarism, or other unethical behaviour is an immediate disqualification. **A note on AI.** I can't detect AI-generated code, so this isn't a bannable-offence, but I encourage everyone to think through your own strategies. AlgoJam's real prizes are the problems and humans you meet along the way!

Event Schedule

Friday - Welcome Night

6:00 PM start (Australia/Brisbane). Enjoy some catering while we run through a quick overview of what the data looks like, the competition rules, a demo of how to write an algorithm, and how to submit it on Sunday night.

Location: 42-216 Prentice Building, UQ

Google Meet: <https://meet.google.com/mpw-owmq-naf>

Saturday and Sunday are building days, for teams to develop and refine their algorithms.

Monday - Presentation Night

6:00 PM start (Australia/Brisbane). Enjoy some catering while we hear a word from our sponsors, the unseen (Round 2) data is released, and we watch a live P&L race between all teams. Awards and prizes are then presented to the top 5 teams by IMC's campus ambassador, followed by networking.

Location: 42-216 Prentice Building, UQ

Google Meet: <https://meet.google.com/mux-ucmo-snt>

Joining from elsewhere? Both nights are livestreamed on Google Meet using the links above.

Attendance required for prizes

Livestream access covers watching along and appearing on the leaderboard; it does not cover prize eligibility. To be considered for a prize, every member of your team must attend Presentation Night **in person**, in addition to the Queensland-enrolment requirement below.

Eligibility

AlgoJam 3 is to any university student. Teams must have one to four students each.

- **Podium repeat rule:** if any member of a team was part of a top-3 (podium) finishing team in a previous AlgoJam, that team is not eligible for prizes this year.
- **In-person attendance required for prizes:** every member of a prize-eligible team must attend Awards Night in person. Teams who can't attend in person are welcome to compete and appear on the leaderboard, but won't be in the running for prizes.

Interstate & International Teams

Anyone, anywhere, can enter AlgoJam 3. There's no location or enrolment requirement to register a team, submit an algorithm, or appear on the leaderboard on Presentation night. Both Welcome Night and Presentation Night are fully livestreamed, so remote teams can follow along without travelling to Queensland. Prizes are a separate matter. Only teams where every member is currently enrolled at a University based in Queensland, **and** where every member attends Presentation Night in person, are eligible for prizes. Interstate and international teams are welcome to compete for the experience and the leaderboard spot, but won't be in the running for prizes.

Submission Guidelines

Each team submits their solution as an `algorithm.py` file (Python 3.14) by email to:

secretary@uqfintech.org

This email is also how you register your team; there's no separate sign-up step. Along with your `algorithm.py` file, include your team name, an optional team logo, and each member's name and university.

- Include your **expected Round 1 P&L**, plus any instructions needed to run your algorithm.
- Sent more than one submission? We'll use the **most recent**, unless you've told us otherwise.

Key Dates

- **6:00 PM Sunday** - submission deadline
- **6:00–6:30 PM Sunday** - late window, a flat **20% penalty** applies to the final score
- **6:30 PM Sunday** - hard cutoff; submissions after this time will not be considered

Not-Allowed Coding Practices

- **No sandbox escaping / system access.** Your `algorithm.py` must stay within the `get_positions()` interface; no file system access beyond the main directory, no spawning processes, no inspecting or modifying the marking environment, no OS/process-level imports.
- **No network access.** No outbound calls of any kind: no APIs, no fetching external data, no DNS. All instruments are self-contained.
- **Resource limits.** Total size (`algorithm.py` + any generated/dependent files) $\leq$ **100 MB**. Full run (all days, both rounds) must complete within **12 minutes** of compute time.

- **Seed your randomness.** If your algorithm uses any randomness (e.g. `random`, `numpy.random`), it must be fixed with a seed so that your submission's behaviour is reproducible.

Scoring & Adjudication

Teams can only see the first 365 days of Round 1 data. Submissions are assessed on **total profit accrued across the next 365 days of unseen (Round 2) data**. When two teams tie, Sharpe ratio will be the tie-breaker.

Approved libraries

Any Python library is permitted, provided it doesn't violate the sandbox, network, or resource-limit rules set out in Section 4.1 above. If you're reaching for something unusual, double-check it against those rules first, and ask the executive team if you're unsure.

Integrity & Disqualification

This will get you disqualified

- Plagiarism or submitting work that isn't your team's own
- Unauthorised collaboration between teams
- Manipulating or tampering with competition data
- Violating the sandbox, network, or resource-limit rules above

Enquiries

Please ask any questions in the `#algojam` channel on our Discord, [UQ Fintech Society](#), or email secretary@uqfintech.org.